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Running the shell

Method

Use compositor autostart as the primary method.

Autostart by your Wayland compositor

This is the recommended method for launching noctalia-shell, as it integrates with your window manager.

For the *Niri* compositor, add the following line to the end of your configuration file, typically located at `~/.config/niri/config.kdl`

```
spawn-at-startup "qs" "-c" "noctalia-shell"
```

For the *Hyprland* compositor, append this line to your configuration file, typically located at `~/.config/hypr/hyprland.conf`

```
exec-once = qs -c noctalia-shell
```

Important

- Be aware that the command might need to be adjusted based on how you installed noctalia-shell.
- **Manual installation:** If you installed Noctalia into `~/.config/quickshell/`, you can use `qs` to start it. For keybindings, you must use `qs ipc ...` instead.

Manual Launch for Debugging

This page contains information about how to manually launch the shell for debugging purposes.

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```
qs -c noctalia-shell
```